

Huge fan of 'selfies'? You should try 'drones'

Drones are the helicopter-like flying devices that the military has used for years for surveillance and monitoring. These drones are now coming to the electronic consumers market, and have been used in agriculture, photography of houses by estate agents, gathering news, children's toys, etc. Drones were of no use to mainstream users until someone came up with the idea of using drones for clicking airborne 'selfies.'

There are quite a few drone cameras available in the market. The Hexo Plus drone is compatible with GoPro camera. This drone follows and films autonomously. Another competitor product AirDog also tracks and follows you, meanwhile snaps photos and videos of you and your action sport.

If you take a look at the amount of funding these products raised on Kickstarter, you realise that people are eager to buy and experience these kinds of products. Airdog quickly raised \$200,000 while Hexo Plus was hoping to raise \$50,000 but, within three days, it passed \$700,000. Twitter showcased a company-sponsored account, Dronie, at Cannes Lions International Festival of Creativity recently, using which people can take free dronie-selfie videos.

Flying drones is not that easy. It's as difficult as driving a car for the first time. A runner at west Australian triathlon was hit by the drone in April. Drones can sometimes crash into people too.

Learn without paying attention using smart gloves

Researchers from Georgia Institute of Technology have succeeded in building a pair of smart gloves for blind people. The gloves are based on passive haptic feedback learning. In



Hexo drone (Courtesy: <http://www.tuxboard.com>)

haptic learning process, vibrations are used to guide a subject to learn motor skills even when they are not paying any attention. Blind people can read and write Braille script without paying much attention using these gloves.

The motors used in these gloves are programmed to give feedback in the same sequence as Braille typing pattern. Researchers have attached vibrating motors in the knuckles of these gloves. During the test participants were supposed to type words that they had learnt.

A group of people who had no idea about Braille script participated in the test. Participants were introduced to repeated vibration sequences while they were playing a game for 30 minutes. The research team instructed them to ignore audio cues and focus on a game. Once 30 minutes were over, participants were asked to repeat the sequence. Even though they were distracted while learning vibration sequences, their answers were accurate. Most of the people learnt 70 per cent of Braille script after the test.

A pair of jeans to fight against rape

Two young Indian women have come up with a creative way to combat their country's pervasive rape problem: a pair of high-tech jeans.

Students Diksha Pathak, 21, and

Anjali Srivastava, 23, of Varanasi designed a pair of red pants outfitted with a small electronic button that sends a distress call to the nearest police station when pressed. The signal acts as a tracker, so police can rush straight to the victim's location. There are already as many as 200 police stations capable of receiving the alarm in Varanasi and its surrounding areas. Tests will be carried out soon, and lawmakers may press for the technology to be used nationwide if they are successful.

Pathak joined forces with Srivastava, who is studying electronic communication, to invent the device, which lasts for about three months be-



Outraged by the prevalence of sexual violence against women in India, students Diksha Pathak (left) and Anjali Srivastava have created a high-tech pair of jeans designed to prevent rape (Courtesy: <http://nypost.com>)